

Problem 5. Question Formation Process

Solution:

In English, the declarative sentence is in the Subject, verb, Object order. (SVO) The question is formed with a [wh] question in the initial position and is joined by a do + Subject + Verb.

In Simte, the declarative sentence is in SOV order + Sentence completion marker. The question in this language is formed with a [wh] question in the beginning like English + O + V + Question marker. In this language, unlike English, we cannot use the [wh] by itself but rather have to use a corresponding noun. Thus the [wh] is used as rather a modifier.

In Marathi, the declarative sentence is in the order SOV. The question is formed with the [wh] question appearing in the same position as the object in the declarative sentence. So the order in the question process is: S + [wh] + V.

In Japanese, the order of the declarative sentence is: S + TOP + O + V. The question is formed with a [wh] question appearing in the same position as the object in the declarative sentence. This is similar to the question formation process in Marathi. However like Simte it takes a Question Marker at the end of the question.